

Express Entry Pre-Submission Audit Guide

A 40-point audit of your complete e-APR, organised the way a reviewing officer reads your file. Work through every point; each one states what to check and how to fix what you find.

Most refusals are not eligibility failures - they are documentation failures on files that would otherwise have been approved. This audit is designed to be run twice: once when your documents are assembled, and once in the final week before submission.

How to run the audit

Auditing is adversarial reading. For every document, ask the officer's question: *can I verify this, and does it contradict anything else in the file?* Anything you cannot answer cleanly needs fixing at source or a Letter of Explanation.

A. Identity and civil status

1. Passport validity

Check: Passport valid well beyond submission; biographical page scan is sharp, complete, uncropped.

Why / fix: Renew first if expiry is near - your PR visa/COPR cannot outlive the passport it is issued against.

2. One name, everywhere

Check: Name identical across passport, forms, letters, ECA, and test results - or every variant is explained.

Why / fix: Add a name-variation LOE plus linking evidence (affidavit, marriage certificate) for any mismatch, however small.

3. Date and place of birth consistency

Check: DOB and birthplace match on passport, birth certificate, and every form field.

Why / fix: A single transposed digit here reads as carelessness at best, misrepresentation at worst. Fix at source before filing.

4. Marital status evidence

Check: Married: certificate. Common-law: IMM 5409 + 12-month cohabitation evidence. Divorced: certificate + separation agreement. Widowed: death certificate.

Why / fix: The declared status must match the evidence AND the history in both partners' documents.

5. Dependants documented

Check: Birth certificate for each dependent child; adoption certificate where applicable; all dependants declared - accompanying or not.

Why / fix: Undeclared family members are a classic misrepresentation finding and can bar future sponsorship.

B. Language evidence

6. Two-year validity at submission

Check: Test results will still be under 2 years old on the day you SUBMIT the e-APR - not just at ITA.

Why / fix: If results lapse mid-window, retest immediately or the claimed points evaporate and the file fails eligibility.

7. Accepted test and format

Check: English: CELPIP-General, IELTS General Training, or PTE Core. IELTS Academic and One Skill Retake are not accepted.

Why / fix: A perfect score on the wrong test is worth zero points.

8. Per-ability CLB claims match the TRF

Check: Each ability's claimed CLB matches the equivalency chart exactly against your actual report form.

Why / fix: Check the per-ability minimums - your weakest ability sets your program eligibility.

9. Report is verifiable

Check: TRF/report number legible; the copy uploaded is the complete official document, not a screenshot.

Why / fix: Officers verify scores directly with the test provider.

10. Spouse language evidence

Check: If claiming spouse language points, their test meets the same validity and format rules.

Why / fix: Spouse points claimed without a valid test on file is a common silent eligibility error.

C. Education and ECA

11. Designated organization

Check: ECA from WES, ICAS, CES, IQAS, or ICES - or the designated professional body for architects, doctors, pharmacists.

Why / fix: Any other assessor's report is not accepted for Express Entry.

12. Five-year ECA validity

Check: ECA under 5 years old at profile AND at submission.

Why / fix: An expired ECA invalidates the education points it supported.

13. Claimed level equals assessed level

Check: The credential level in your profile matches the ECA outcome - not the certificate's own title.

Why / fix: If the ECA assessed your Master's as Bachelor's-equivalent, the profile must say Bachelor's. Recalculate CRS accordingly.

14. Transcripts and certificates enclosed

Check: Degree certificate + transcripts uploaded where the checklist requires them, translations included.

Why / fix: The ECA report alone is not always sufficient - follow your personalized checklist.

15. Canadian credentials evidenced

Check: Canadian study claimed for points has the credential + proof it met the in-Canada study conditions.

Why / fix: Canadian post-secondary credentials add 15-30 Section D points - officers check the basis.

D. Work history

16. The 11-element reference letter

Check: Every letter: letterhead, date, full name, titles, dates per role, 5+ duties, hours/week, salary + currency, signatory details, stamp/seal, signature.

Why / fix: Reissue any letter missing even one element - this is the single most common refusal trigger.

17. Duties mirror the NOC

Check: Duties in each letter substantively match the NOC lead statement and main duties for the code claimed.

Why / fix: Copy-pasting the NOC text verbatim looks fabricated; mirror the substance in the employer's own language.

18. TEER level supported

Check: Nothing in any letter reads like a lower-TEER role than claimed.

Why / fix: One stray 'data entry and filing' line can sink a TEER 1 claim.

19. Dates reconcile everywhere

Check: Start/end dates identical across letters, payslips, appointment and relieving letters, tax records, and the form.

Why / fix: Build a one-page timeline first; fix discrepancies at source or explain them in an LOE.

20. Gaps declared

Check: Every period since the personal-history start date is accounted for - employment, study, unemployment, travel.

Why / fix: Blank months invite procedural fairness letters. Declare, date, and where needed explain.

21. Self-employment fully evidenced

Check: Self-employed periods have registration, client contracts, invoices, and income proof - not just a self-declaration.

Why / fix: Thin self-employment evidence is treated as unverifiable and scores zero.

22. Current job letter is current

Check: The letter for ongoing employment is recently issued and states 'to present'.

Why / fix: A letter older than ~6 months at submission invites an updated request - pre-empt it.

E. Police certificates

23. Coverage map complete

Check: Certificate for every country of 6+ consecutive months in the last 10 years, for you and each family member 18+.

Why / fix: Draw the residence map first; a missed country is an automatic incompleteness problem.

24. Scope of each certificate

Check: Each certificate covers the full relevant period and any names used during it.

Why / fix: Order under every name variant the issuing authority indexes.

25. In-time strategy

Check: Any certificate that cannot arrive by day 60 has dated proof of request + LOE ready.

Why / fix: IRCC accepts proof-of-request at submission; silence it does not.

26. Validity at submission

Check: Certificates are recent enough per the country-specific rules in your personalized checklist.

Why / fix: Some countries' certificates age out quickly - sequence your orders so none expires before you file.

F. Medical

27. Panel physician only

Check: Exam done by an IRCC-designated panel physician - a family doctor's checkup does not count.

Why / fix: Book via the canada.ca panel physician finder; one appointment only, close to your application date.

28. Proof uploaded

Check: Information printout sheet or IMM 1017B uploaded in the medical slot.

Why / fix: The clinic transmits results electronically, but your proof document must still be in the file.

29. Whole family examined

Check: Every family member has an exam - including dependants not coming to Canada.

Why / fix: A missing non-accompanying dependant's exam stalls the whole application.

G. Funds

30. Live threshold check

Check: Balance clears the CURRENT canada.ca amount for your family size - checked this week, not last year.

Why / fix: Amounts update annually from LICO figures; keep a buffer of several thousand dollars above the line.

31. Family size arithmetic

Check: Family size counts your spouse and all dependent children - even if not accompanying.

Why / fix: The most common threshold miscalculation.

32. Six-month stability

Check: Statements show a stable 6-month history; every large credit has a documented source.

Why / fix: Sudden spikes without a paper trail are a leading refusal cause - see the source-of-funds LOE.

33. Bank letter contents

Check: Official letterhead letter: accounts, opening dates, current and 6-month average balance, and outstanding debts.

Why / fix: A plain statement printout is not a bank letter.

34. Acceptable funds only

Check: Liquid, unencumbered, in your (or partner's) name. No property equity, no borrowed money, no locked accounts.

Why / fix: Gifted funds need a notarized non-repayable gift deed + donor evidence.

35. Exemption letter if exempt

Check: CEC applicants and valid-job-offer holders upload a letter explaining the exemption in the POF slot.

Why / fix: The system asks everyone for a POF document - the letter is how exempt applicants answer it.

H. Final form and submission

36. Every checklist slot filled

Check: Each slot in the personalized checklist has the right document - nothing skipped, nothing misfiled.

Why / fix: A wrong-slot upload is functionally a missing document.

37. Translation compliance

Check: Non-English/French documents: certified translation (or translator's affidavit) + original/certified copy, stamps translated too.

Why / fix: Untranslated seals are a surprisingly common completeness flag.

38. Representative and consent forms

Check: IMM 5476 if anyone assists you for a fee or represents you; IMM 5475 if authorising information release.

Why / fix: Undeclared paid representation is itself a misrepresentation risk.

39. The cold-read

Check: Someone (ideally not you) reads the entire file start to finish as an officer would, flagging anything that raises a question.

Why / fix: Every flag gets fixed or gets an LOE - before submission, not after a fairness letter.

40. Beat the clock deliberately

Check: Submission planned with buffer days before the 60-day deadline; fees ready; account access confirmed.

Why / fix: Day-59 submissions have no room for a rejected upload or a payment failure.

Scoring your audit

Result	Reading	Action
40 / 40 clean	File is submission-ready.	Submit with your planned buffer.
1-3 flags	Typical first audit.	Fix at source where possible; LOE where not; re-run.
4+ flags	Do not submit yet.	The pattern itself signals rushed assembly - rebuild the weak sections, then re-run the full audit.

Sources

Every rule and figure in this document was verified against the following official pages on 19 July 2026:

- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/apply-permanent-residence.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/language-test.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/education-assessment.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/police-certificates.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/proof-funds.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/after-apply.html

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